

Assignment 1; due Thursday, September 24, 2026

- [1] Let $E \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ be nonempty. We say that $t \in \mathbb{R}$ is a *lower bound* of E if $t \leq x$ for all $x \in E$. We say that E is *bounded below* if there exists a lower bound of E . We say that $t \in \mathbb{R}$ is a *greatest lower bound*, or *infimum*, of E if it is a lower bound of E and if $t \geq s$ for any lower bound s of E . If E has an infimum, it is denoted $\inf E$.
- [a] Let E be a nonempty subset of $\mathbb{R}$ which is bounded below. Find a way to use the completeness axiom to prove that $\inf E$ exists. *Hint*: Consider the subset $-E = \{-x : x \in E\}$.
- [b] Let $\emptyset \neq A \subseteq B \subseteq \mathbb{R}$. Suppose B is bounded below (so $\inf B$ exists). Prove that A is bounded below (so $\inf A$ exists) and that $\inf A \geq \inf B$.
- [c] Let A, B be nonempty subsets of $\mathbb{R}$, both bounded below (so both $\inf A$ and $\inf B$ exist.) Define

$$A + B = \{a + b : a \in A, b \in B\}.$$

Prove that $A + B$ is bounded below and that $\inf(A + B) = \inf A + \inf B$.

- [2] Let x, y be two real numbers such that $y - x > 1$. (In particular, $x < y$.)
- [a] If x is positive, prove that there exists an integer $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $x < k < y$.
- [b] If x is negative and y is positive, prove that there exists an integer $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $x < k < y$.
- [c] If y is negative, prove that there exists an integer $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $x < k < y$.

- [3] The parts of this problem are *not* related.
- [a] Let $x \in \mathbb{R}$. Consider the set $E = \{q \in \mathbb{Q} : q < x\} \subset \mathbb{Q} \subset \mathbb{R}$. Show that E is nonempty and bounded above, so $\sup E$ exists. Show also that $\sup E = x$.
- [b] Let $x, y \in \mathbb{R}$ with $x < y$. Prove that there exists an *irrational* (not rational) number z such that $x < z < y$. *Hint*: You may use the fact that $\sqrt{2}$ is irrational.

- [4] Let $C > 0$ be a fixed positive number.
- [a] Let $x \geq 0$, and suppose that *for any* $\varepsilon > 0$, we have $x < C\varepsilon$. Show that for any $\eta > 0$, we have $x < \eta$.
- [b] In the situation of part [a], show that we must have $x = 0$. *Hint*: Find a way to use the Archimedean property.

[5] COMING SOON

[6] COMING SOON

[7] COMING SOON

[8] COMING SOON

[9] COMING SOON

[10] COMING SOON